

Jacob Berger

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Education

Oregon State University — Corvallis, OR

Ph.D. & M.S. in Artificial Intelligence

Expected June 2030

Advisor: Dr. Lizhong Chen, STAR Lab. Coursework: Deep Learning, Parallel Programming, Operating Systems II, Numerical ODEs/PDEs, Math of Data Science, Analysis of Algorithms, Machine Learning.

Honors B.S. in Applied Computer Science & Computational Mathematics

Sept 2022 – June 2026

Summa Cum Laude (both degrees)

Accelerated Master's Program (graduate coursework as undergraduate). Honors degree. AI concentration, double major.

Research Experience

Honors Thesis: Semantic Constraints in NLP

June 2025 – June 2026

Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Lizhong Chen, STAR Lab)

- Developed Parsimonious Decoding and Vocabulary Efficiency Score (VES) for Natural Semantic Metalanguage; evaluated five LLMs, raising base-model semantic-legality scores from 8.1–10.3% to 52.0–78.0%.

Experience

Graduate Research Assistant

June 2026 – Present

Oregon State University, STAR Lab — Corvallis, OR

- Conducting funded research on LLMs and deep learning for scientific computing under Dr. Lizhong Chen.

Technical Contributor & Cofounder

March 2023 – Present

Lexel Synergetics — Portland, OR

- Led proposal writing and secured a Phase I SBIR grant (federal R&D funding) for NLP-based language model development.
- Architected end-to-end data pipelines for training and fine-tuning specialized large language models (LoRA, RAG).
- Deployed cloud infrastructure on AWS, GCP, and Vercel for model training and serving.

Head Mechanic

Dec 2022 – June 2026

MU Lanes and Games — Corvallis, OR

- Managed maintenance and diagnostics for electromechanical bowling lane systems.

Projects

Senior Capstone: AI for Home Automation

Sept 2025 – June 2026

- Integrated LLMs with Home Assistant for natural-language home automation. Presented at OSU Engineering Research Expo.

AuTuber — AI Stage Hand for Live Streaming

May 2026 (BeaverHacks)

- LLM-driven agent observing webcam, screen, and audio to autonomously control OBS and VTube Studio via WebSocket. Team of 4, served as PM and technical lead.

RelCube — Deep RL Rubik's Cube Solver

Winter 2026

- Transformer-based solver (~3.5M params) using structured piece representation. Trained with Approximate Value Iteration and Expanding Curriculum. Team of 3.

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, C++, Java, JavaScript, Bash, x86 Assembly, MATLAB
- **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, LLM Fine-tuning (LoRA), RAG Pipelines, Reinforcement Learning
- **Systems & Cloud:** Linux (Debian), Proxmox VE, Virtualization (LXC/KVM), AWS (EC2/S3), GCP, Git, Vercel
- **Human Languages:** Fluent Spanish (9 years immersion)

Awards

- Putnam Math Competition: Top 3 finisher at OSU (2022 competition); 11 points in 2025.
- Finley Academic Excellence Scholarship: \$20,000 merit scholarship, 2022.

Extracurriculars

- **Competitive Math:** OSU Putnam and COMAP Math Modeling (implemented Cellular Automata for ecosystem resilience analysis).
- **Competitive Sports:** Founded OSU national collegiate bowling team (All-Star qualifier); Rose City Rowing Club leader (2-time national qualifier).